03-10 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Yawn?

① You are sitting in a quiet classroom on Monday afternoon. The teacher is reading from page 56. Suddenly, the boy beside you opens his mouth wide and takes a long, slow breath. Two seconds later, a girl behind you does the same. Soon, yawns travel around the room like a soft wave. Why do humans — and many animals — **yawn**? And why does one yawn so quickly lead to another?

② For many years, people believed that yawning brings more oxygen to a tired brain. This sounds reasonable, but modern tests do not fully support it. When scientists asked volunteers to breathe pure oxygen or low-oxygen air, the number of yawns did not change much. Clearly, oxygen is part of the story, but not the whole story.

③ A newer idea, tested at Princeton University, is that yawning helps **cool the brain**. Our brain works better when it stays a little below the body temperature. When we are sleepy, bored, or sitting in a warm room, our brain may rise in temperature. Opening the mouth wide lets cooler air rush in and flow past blood vessels near the roof of the mouth. Like a small fan, the yawn brings the brain back to a better working temperature.

④ This idea also helps explain why yawns are more common in the **late afternoon**, when classrooms feel stuffy, or at night before bed. It also explains why some athletes yawn **before** a big game. They are not tired — their brains are actually getting ready to focus hard, and a quick cool-down may help them think faster.

⑤ But why is yawning so "catchy"? You see someone yawn, and you feel your own mouth pulling open. Scientists believe this is linked to **empathy** — the ability to understand other people's feelings. Tests on children show that babies do not "catch" yawns from adults, but children aged four and above begin to do so. Dogs, too, yawn more often when their owner is yawning nearby, perhaps a sign that they truly care about the person.

⑥ So, next time you feel a yawn coming, don't be too quick to feel sorry. A yawn is not always a sign of a bored mind. It might be your clever brain saying: "I need a little fresh air and a little cool breeze, so I can listen better to the next page." In fact, a yawn in the classroom might just be the first step to a stronger, sharper lesson.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What does the writer mainly want to discuss?

A. How to stop yawning in class.
B. Why we yawn and why yawning is "catchy".
C. How teachers can make lessons more fun.
D. What happens to people who yawn too loudly.

2. According to Paragraph 2, what did the oxygen tests show?

A. People need much more oxygen than before.
B. Oxygen alone cannot fully explain why we yawn.
C. People stop yawning when they breathe pure oxygen.
D. Oxygen tests are not useful in real life.

3. According to Paragraph 3, what does a yawn do for our brain?

A. It warms up the brain on cold days.
B. It brings in cool air that helps lower the brain's temperature.
C. It helps the brain to fall asleep faster.
D. It stops new ideas from forming.

4. Why might some athletes yawn BEFORE a big game?

A. They are tired and want to leave.
B. They are afraid of losing.
C. Their brain is getting ready to focus, and the yawn helps cool it down.
D. They want to make the other team laugh.

5. What do we learn from the babies-and-dogs test in Paragraph 5?

A. Yawns become "catchy" only after we grow up a little and show empathy.
B. Dogs can teach babies to yawn.
C. Babies yawn more often than teenagers.
D. Only humans yawn when they see others yawn.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第①段末两句问题 + 全文结构
【解析】作者通过两个核心问题展开讨论打哈欠的原因与传染性。A、C、D 偏题。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段末两句 "oxygen is part of the story, but not the whole story"

【解析】氧气不能完全解释打哈欠。A 与实验事实相反；C 与实验结果相反；D 无依据。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "cooler air rush in... brings the brain back to a better working temperature"
【解析】哈欠带入冷空气冷却大脑。A 与原文相反；C、D 无依据。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第④段末两句 "getting ready to focus hard... a quick cool-down may help"
【解析】运动员赛前打哈欠是大脑在准备专注+快速降温。A、B、D 均与文意不符。故选 C。

5.
【答案】A
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑤段 "babies do not 'catch' yawns... children aged four and above begin to do so... empathy"
【解析】婴儿不会"传染哈欠"，大一些才会，说明与共情能力有关。B、C、D 均与文意不符。故选 A。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **yawn** [v./n.] 打哈欠
- **empathy** [n.] 共情；同理心
- **blood vessel** 血管